

Colonial History

- Spain gained Mexico territory
- Mexicans learned Spanish and were Christian to keep local power
- Mexico's native population declined from around 25 million in 1519 to 1 million in 1622
- Encomienda gave native's right of labor to Spanish
 - slavery, natives worked for Spanish
 - work was plantation or farming related
 - also can be found in gold and silver mines
- People criticized encomienda system for being unfair
- King Charles V made laws in 1542 that made the encomienda system die out at 2nd half of 17th century
- Repartimiento system replaced it and was based on wage and different labor demands on different native communities
- Both died out when mestizo and Spanish population began to rise and African slave labor happened

